Listening comprehension exercise

You will hear five different people talking about extreme weather events that they have seen. For questions 1-5 choose from the list (A-H) what each speaker says about what happened. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

A. I was injured while it was going on. B. I was glad I'd decided to go by train. C. I had to swim to reach safety. D. I stayed where I was all the time it was happening. E. I managed to help some people while it was going on. F. It was fortunate that I found a place to take shelter. G. It was more severe than in previous years. H. I wasn't sure what to do in the situation.	Speaker 1 Speaker 2 Speaker 3 Speaker 4 Speaker 5

Reading comprehension exercise

You are going to read an article about the growing amount of waste created by electronic goods. Six sentences have been removed from the article. Choose from the sentences A- The one which fits each gap (1-6). There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

The problem of electronic waste

(Michael McCarthy)

Modem electronic devices might look clean on the outside, but inside they contain a lot of materials used in manufacture which may be dangerous to human health. Most of these substances can be removed safely, but a lot of investment in waste-handling equipment is needed to do so. Many countries have refused to make the investment and instead taken the 'out of sight, out of mind' attitude, and simply shipped their e-waste abroad, usually to developing nations. 1/….

1

The latest United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) report estimates that, worldwide, electronic waste is increasing by about 40 million tons a year. Globally more than a billion mobile phones were sold last year, with most of them likely to be thrown away at the end of their lives. In many parts of Africa, telephone communications have skipped the landline stage and gone from no phones to mobile phones in one step. 2/…. 'The issue is exploding,' says Ruediger Kuehr, of the United Nations University in Tokyo.

2

So, what can we do about it? The first thing to do is recognise the problem. The electronics revolution of the past 30 years has seemed different in kind from the original industrial revolution with its chimneys pouring out very obvious dirt. 3/…. But we have gradually come to realise that, in two ways in particular, modern hi-tech can be bad for the planet too. 3

The first is its energy use; the worldwide scale of information technology is so enormous that electronics now produce fully two per cent of global carbon emissions, which is about the same as the highly controversial emissions of aeroplanes 4/… This, increasingly, is pretty short. We have hardly noticed this important stream of waste, so much so that a Greenpeace report on e-waste two years ago referred to it as 'the hidden flow'. We need to be aware of it. 4

The European Union has recognised the problem by adopting a key principle: producer responsibility. 5/…. In practice, an EU regulation now means that electronics dealers must either take back the equipment they sold you, or help to finance a network of drop-off points, such as council recycling sites. Its main feature is quite ambitious: it aims to deal with "everything with plug". 5

The new UN report suggests that all countries should start to establish proper e-waste management networks, which could both cut down on health problems and generate employment, reduce greenhouse gas emissions and recover a wide range of valuable substances from gold to copper. They could also do something about the problem with a change in design. Groups such as Greenpeace have led the way in putting pressure on major manufacturing companies to find substitutes for the toxic chemicals inside their production. 6/…. This may be the real way forward. 6

A. Encouragingly, they have had some success in forcing them to develop non-poisonous alternatives to these.

B. In other words. making it the duty of manufacturers of electronic goods to ensure their safe disposal at the end of their lives.

C. Compared with that, it has seemed clean and green.

D. Much of this, such as the plastic covering on cables, is worth nothing at all.

E. There, instead of being properly processed, items are either dumped in unmanaged landfills or broken up in unofficial recycling facilities - often by children.

F. Add to that the vast amounts of e-waste that are still being imported from rich countries, and you have an enormous e-waste mountain in prospect, with its corresponding dangers for human health and the environment.

G. The other is the hardware, when it comes to the end of its natural life.

Sentence transformation

For questions 1-6, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. Do not change the word given. You must use between two and five words, including the word given. Here is an example:

My advice to you is to change your job.
IF
I'd change .....MY JOB IF I WERE..... you.

I didn't call because I forgot your phone number.
WOULD
I _____ hadn't forgotten your phone number.

Carmen is a better driver than her boyfriend.
SO
Carmen's boyfriend doesn't _____ she does.

Some people don't agree with the idea of building more power stations.
IN
Some people _____ of building more power stations.

I missed the speech because my train was late.
ARRIVED
If my train hadn't been late, I
_____ time for the speech.

Burning rubbish is probably more harmful than burying it.
NOT
Burying rubbish is _____ burning it.

These energy-saving measures don't work because we started them too late.
HAD
These energy-saving measures
_____ started them sooner.

Writing – essay
(see also booklet 3)

Your English class has done a project on the subject of the environment. Now, your teacher has asked you to write an essay.
Write an essay using all the notes and give reasons for your point of view.

> We are not doing enough to protect our world.
> Notes:
> *1 the harm we are doing to the environment*
> *2 what we are doing to save the environment*
> *3 your own idea …*

Write your essay in 140-190 words. You must use grammatically correct sentences with accurate spelling and punctuation in an appropriate style.

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Contrast – linking words

Choose the correct option.

1. Even though / Despite it had stopped raining, the river was still rising.
2. These trees reach their full height quickly, nevertheless, / whereas those grow more slowly.
3. Coastal areas are becoming wetter. In contrast, / While the interior is getting drier every year.
4. On the other hand, / Despite the fact that it is a beautiful country, few people visit it.
5. In contrast, / Despite the strong wind, the ferry arrived on time.
6. On the one hand, cars are now designed to pollute less. On the other hand, / Whereas there are far more of them.

Writing · essay: your answer (140-190 words)

We are not doing enough to protect our world.

Contrast linking words · answers

Choose the correct option.

1. Even though / Despite it had stopped raining, the river was still rising.
2. These trees reach their full height quickly, nevertheless, / whereas those grow more slowly.
3. Coastal areas are becoming wetter. In contrast, / While the interior is getting drier every year.
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Grammar Reference

CONDITIONALS

Look at these sentences. In each case, say which verb forms are used and answer the corresponding questions.

a) If I have to travel next Christmas, I'll take the train.
b) If it happened again, I'd find somewhere safe much sooner.
c) If I'd stayed there, I would've been in big trouble.

a) Will she definitely travel next Christmas? Is it likely or unlikely that she will take the train?
b) Is it likely or unlikely to happen again? Will she probably need to find somewhere safe again?
c) Did she stay there? Was she in big trouble?

Match the sentence halves.

1 If it doesn't rain soon, ____
2 If the river had risen any higher, ____
3 If the warm Atlantic current stopped, ____
4 Unless it stops snowing, ____
5 If the desert had a rainy season, ____

a- the airport will be closed.
b- Western Europe would get much colder.
c- there won't be any water for the crops.
d- it would be possible to live there.
e- it might have flooded the city.

Correct the mistakes in these sentences.

1 If I were you, I will try to have a rest.

2 If I had studied more, I would have write to you in Spanish.

3 If I would live near my work, I would prefer to go by bicycle.

4 If the climate keeps changing, we would have only two seasons.

5 Frankly, if I had a lot of money, I would have spend my entire life shopping.

6 If I would have known what was going to happen that night, I would never have gone there.

Conditionals · answers to the first exercise

Say which verb forms are used and answer the corresponding questions.

a) If I have to travel next Christmas, I'll take the train.

b) If it happened again, I'd find somewhere safe much sooner.

c) If I'd stayed there, I would've been in big trouble.

Use the given conditional form to complete the questions. Then work in pairs and ask your partner the questions.

1) If the weather _____ (be) fine this weekend, where _____ (you go)? (first conditional)
2) If the summers where you live _____ (become) much hotter, what _____ (you do)? (second conditional)
3) If _____ (you be able) to control the weather, what _____ (the seasons be) like? (second conditional)
4) What _____ (you do) last week if bad weather _____ (not/prevent) you from going out? (third conditional)

Mixed conditionals

In these sentences, second and third conditional forms are mixed:

- If the tornado hadn't changed direction, I wouldn't be here now.
- If I had a bigger car, I could have slept in it last night.

Use mixed conditionals to complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

1 You're not cold now because you brought your coat.
You would be cold now if _____

2 I have to work this month, so I couldn't go skiing with my friends last week.
If I didn't have to work this month, I _____

3 Those drivers are stuck in the snow because they didn't check the weather forecast.
If those drivers had checked the weather forecast, they _____

4 We polluted the air for many years, so now the climate is changing.
The climate wouldn't be changing now if we _____

5 Your bill is so high because you wasted so much electricity.
If you hadn't wasted so much electricity, your bill _____

6 The summer heat in Italy didn't bother me because I'm from Australia.
The summer heat in Italy might have bothered me if _____

Work in pairs. Imagine these situations and tell your partner about them, using mixed conditionals.
1) You grew up in another country, with a different climate and way of life. How would your life be different now?
2) You're with somebody of another nationality who lives in your country. What would he have had to get used to?

Phrases (expressions) with IN

Match the underlined phrases with meanings a-j.

1 In all, there were 20 volunteers working on the project. 1 ____
2 Work is in progress on a new wind-power scheme. 2 ____
3 I am in favour of banning cars from the town centre. 3 ____
4 The results will be made known in due course. 4 ____
5 In practice, the new regulations have done little to reduce waste. 5 ____
6 When we decide what to do, we'll need to bear in mind the cost. 6 ____
7 Rising sea levels will do damage in the long term. 7 ____
8 Everyone should play a part in helping to conserve areas of natural beauty. 8 ____
9 It's 9.15 and my appointment isn't until 10. In the meantime, I'll text my friends. 9 ____
10 Spending cuts mean that the future of the park is now in doubt. 10 ____

a) the real situation is that
b) over a period of time continuing far into the future
c) at a suitable time in the future
d) happening or being done now
e) agree with an idea or plan
f) be involved in
g) uncertain
h) in the time between two events
i) the total number
j) remember to consider something

Compete the text using phrases with IN

A plan to set up a paper recycling scheme is (1) _____ at our college, enabling everyone to (2) _____ reducing the amount of paper thrown away.

(3) . _____, it means that special bins will be placed at various points in the school, and the paper collected will, (4) _____, be sent for recycling. The original plan was to have a bin outside every room, which would have meant over ninety 5) _____ by the end of this term. That number, though, must now be (6) _____ because of the cost, and they're unlikely to be that many until the end of next year. (7) _____ it will require just a short walk to the nearest collection point. Perhaps the move towards paperless offices will one day reach colleges like mine, so that (8) _____ the bins may not be needed at all.